



Build Steps

Part 1 of 5 · Set up your agent in the new builder

1 Create your agent

Open Copilot Studio (copilotstudio.microsoft.com), select **Create**, then **New agent**. In the redesigned builder everything lives under the **Build** tab, with a settings panel down the right. Set:

Agent name Public Sector Case Triage Copilot

Description Triages incoming citizen and member requests across housing, benefits, permits, complaints and information: categorises, prioritises, picks the SLA, and drafts an acknowledgement letter.

Solution / Environment Public Sector Solution · Default environment

Icon Use a recognisable colour and emoji, or upload a brand icon

2 Choose your model

Open the **Model** selector at the top of the right-hand panel. Copilot Studio now lets you pick the model your agent reasons with. This build uses **Claude Sonnet 4.6**; you can switch later without rebuilding.

Reasoning is built in

- The agent reasons over your instructions, knowledge, skills and tools, and decides what to do each turn
- Handles paraphrases, multi-step asks and follow-ups
- Blends a knowledge lookup with a tool call in one reply
- Calls the right skill when intent matches

Choosing a model

- Claude Sonnet 4.6: strong reasoning, a good default here
- Lighter models: lower latency and cost for simple, high-volume flows
- Switch the model and re-run the same evaluation set to compare
- Check data residency and model availability for your tenant

In the public sector, model choice should account for transparency, accessibility, and data residency: record the model in use, keep an audit trail of automated decisions, and re-run your evaluation set when the model changes.

3 Write your instructions

The **Instructions** box is the heart of the Build tab. Define the agent's role, audiences and rules here. The agent reasons over these together with everything in the right-hand panel. Paste:

You are the Public Sector Case Triage Copilot. You help case officers manage incoming citizen requests.

Rules:

- Use the uploaded case dataset as your single source of truth.
- Always cite the citizen reference for every case you discuss.
- Categorise and prioritise a new case, then pick the right SLA.
- Flag cases breaching or close to breaching SLA at the top of any answer.
- Write acknowledgement letters in plain language at an accessible reading level.
- For a letter, call the 'Create Acknowledgement Letter Draft in Word' tool.



Build Steps

Part 2 of 5 · Ground it in your data

4 Add Knowledge

Open **Knowledge** in the panel, select **Add knowledge**, then **File**, and upload **PublicSector_Cases_Data.xlsx**. Knowledge gives the agent trusted context to guide its answers. This file contains:

- Case details (citizen reference, category, channel, received date)
- Triage data (priority, SLA, assigned officer, status)
- Outcome data (days to resolve, resolution, satisfaction)
- Demand data (category, channel, date for roll-ups)

Layer more sources later: SharePoint sites, Dataverse, Microsoft Graph connectors, or public web.

5 Bring in Microsoft IQ

Open **Microsoft IQ** in the panel. Microsoft IQ brings in work context, business data and app signals from across your tenant, so the agent grounds answers in more than the file you uploaded.

For this agent, Microsoft IQ resolves the case officer and links a case to prior correspondence in the records system, so triage reflects the full history of contact, not just the latest request. Microsoft IQ honours each user's existing permissions, so the agent only surfaces what the signed-in user is already allowed to see.

Build Steps

Part 3 of 5 · Give it skills and tools

6 Add a Skill

Open **Skills** in the panel, then **Add a skill**. A skill defines a reusable behaviour through structured instructions. It is the new home for the conversational flows you used to build as topics: the agent calls the skill when a user's intent matches.

Skill name: Triage New Case

Description: Walks a case officer through categorising and prioritising a new citizen request, picks the right SLA, and offers to draft an acknowledgement letter for the citizen.

When to use it (intent hints the agent reasons over):

- Triage a new case
- Categorise this request
- What SLA applies to this case
- Set up case CIT-7821

Structured steps:

- Capture the request and identify the category (housing, benefits, permits, complaints, information)
- Set the priority and the SLA that applies to the category
- Cite the citizen reference and confirm the assigned officer
- Offer to draft a plain-language acknowledgement letter
- Call 'Create Acknowledgement Letter Draft in Word' if confirmed
- Return the document link for officer review before sending



7 Add a Tool

Open **Tools**, then **Add a tool**. **Skills decide what to do; tools take the action**. A tool is a typed, callable action with named inputs and outputs that the model fills from the conversation. Choose one of: a **prebuilt connector** (Outlook, Teams, SharePoint, Dataverse, ServiceNow and more), a **Power Automate cloud flow**, a **custom HTTP request**, or a **Model Context Protocol (MCP) server**. This build uses a Power Automate flow because it does two things in one call: populate the approved Word template and save the draft to SharePoint, then return a link.

Tool name: Create Acknowledgement Letter Draft in Word

Type: Power Automate flow using the Word for the web connector (Create document from template), plus a SharePoint save

Description (the model reads this to decide when to call): Creates a plain-language acknowledgement letter draft from the approved Word template, populated with citizen reference, category, SLA, and the assigned officer name.

Inputs the agent collects or infers:

- citizenReference — text, from the case the skill is triaging
- category — text, one of Housing / Benefits / Permits / Complaints / Information
- slaDate — date, the SLA the triage step set
- assignedOfficer — text, the case officer name

Outputs returned to the agent:

- documentUrl — text, e.g. <https://contoso.sharepoint.com/.../CIT-7821-acknowledgement.docx>
- documentName — text, e.g. CIT-7821-acknowledgement.docx
- status — text, e.g. Created

7.1 · Build the cloud flow that does the work

From inside Copilot Studio choose **Tools > Add a tool > New > Power Automate**. This opens the flow designer pre-wired with the Copilot Studio trigger and, crucially, keeps the flow in the **same environment** as your agent (Public Sector Solution · Default). An environment mismatch is the most common reason a finished tool never appears in the picker, so confirm the environment switcher (top-right) before you build.

Trigger — *When an agent calls the flow*. Add four input parameters, named exactly: citizenReference (text), category (text), slaDate (date), assignedOfficer (text).

– **Action 1 – populate the template.** Word Online (Business) *Populate a Word template* using the approved **Acknowledgement Letter** template; map the content controls to citizenReference, category, slaDate and assignedOfficer.

– **Action 2 – save the draft.** SharePoint *Create file* into the **Case Letters** library, file name `concat(citizenReference, ' - acknowledgement.docx')`, file content from the populated template output.

– **Action 3 – get the link.** SharePoint *Create sharing link* (or *Get file properties*) so the flow can hand the officer a URL to the saved draft.

– **Final action – return to the agent.** Add *Respond to the agent* (Return value(s) to Copilot Studio) with outputs documentUrl = the sharing link, documentName = the file name, status = 'Created'.

– **Save** the flow as Public Sector – Create Acknowledgement Letter Draft.



7.2 · Register and map the tool in your agent

- Back in Copilot Studio the flow is attached automatically; if you built it separately, **Tools > Add a tool > Flows** and select it.
- Set the display name to **Create Acknowledgement Letter Draft in Word** and write the **Description** for the model — it is what the agent reads to decide when to call the tool.
- For each input set **Fill using**: citizenReference → *dynamically* from the case the skill is triaging; category, slaDate and assignedOfficer → **Fill with AI**, and add an input description so the model extracts the right value (for category, list Housing/Benefits/Permits/Complaints/Information).
- Confirm documentUrl is returned to the agent so the skill can hand the officer a link — satisfying your step “return the document link for officer review before sending”.
- **Connection & auth**: set the Word Online and SharePoint connections the flow uses. The connectors chosen here are exactly what your DLP policy must permit (see Step 10).

7.3 · Worked example — what flows in and out

When a case officer says “draft an acknowledgement for CIT-7821, housing repair request”, the model fills the inputs and calls the tool with this payload:

```
{
  "citizenReference": "CIT-7821",
  "category": "Housing",
  "slaDate": "2026-06-22",
  "assignedOfficer": "Aoife Brennan"
}
```

The flow populates the template, saves the draft, and returns:

```
{
  "documentUrl": "https://contoso.sharepoint.com/.../CIT-7821-acknowledgement.docx",
  "documentName": "CIT-7821-acknowledgement.docx",
  "status": "Created"
}
```

The agent then replies in natural language, linking the real draft: “I’ve drafted the acknowledgement letter for CIT-7821 (Housing, SLA 22 Jun 2026). Open the draft for review before it goes to the citizen.”

7.4 · Test the tool before you trust it

- **In isolation**: open the flow in Power Automate, choose *Test > Manually*, supply the four inputs, run it, and confirm a .docx appears in the Case Letters library populated from the template and that the run returns the link, name and status.
- **End to end**: in **Preview** (Step 11) type “draft an acknowledgement letter for CIT-7821, housing repair request” and check the activity view shows Create Acknowledgement Letter Draft in Word firing with the inputs the model inferred and the link it read back.



Build Steps

Part 4 of 5 · Extend, remember and govern

8 Add Connected agents

Open **Connected agents**. A connected agent lets this agent collaborate with others, delegating specialist work and sharing context across them (agent-to-agent). Keep each agent focused on what it does best.

Connect a **Translation Agent** so an acknowledgement letter can be produced in a citizen's preferred language in the same flow, keeping the drafting agent focused on triage and template.

9 Turn on Memory

Toggle **Memory** on. Memory lets the agent remember interactions, workflows and context across sessions, so returning users do not have to repeat themselves. For this agent it remembers:

- The officer's queue and category mix, so triage opens in context
- Letter drafts already created, so follow-ups need no re-stating

Memory is scoped to each user and follows your retention and DLP policy. Review what the agent retains before you publish.

10 Govern your agent

Open the agent settings and lock these down before real users arrive:

Authentication: use *Authenticate with Microsoft (Entra)* so the agent runs as the signed-in user and inherits their permissions.

Content moderation: set the moderation level (start at Medium) and review it for your audience.

Data loss prevention: confirm your DLP policy covers the connectors your tools use — for Create Acknowledgement Letter Draft in Word that means the Word Online and SharePoint connectors must sit in the same DLP group, or the tool is blocked at runtime.

Channels and access: review which channels are enabled and who can use the agent.

Build Steps

Part 5 of 5 · Preview, evaluate and publish

11 Preview your agent

Switch to the **Preview** tab to chat with your agent as you build. Open the **activity view** on any response to inspect:

- Which skill, tool or knowledge source fired, and in what order
- The inputs the agent collected and what each tool returned
- Citations linking each answer back to a row of your data
- Latency per step, useful when tuning multi-tool flows



12 Evaluate

Open the **Evaluate** tab, then **New evaluation**. Build a test set so you can measure quality before and after every change. Score each response on **groundedness** (did it stay inside the knowledge), **relevance** (did it address the question), and **accuracy** (did it match the expected outcome).

Test set: Public Sector Case Triage · Baseline v1

Input: Show all High priority cases currently breaching SLA

Expect: Returns High priority rows past their SLA date, flagged at the top, with references.

Input: What's the average days-to-resolve by category?

Expect: Calculates average days to resolve per category from the rows.

Input: Draft an acknowledgement letter for CIT-7821, housing repair request

Expect: Triggers the Triage New Case skill and calls Create Acknowledgement Letter Draft in Word.

13 Publish and Monitor

Click **Publish**, then enable the channels your users live in: Microsoft Teams, Microsoft 365 Copilot, a custom website embed, or other channels. Teams and M365 Copilot need tenant admin approval, so plan for that lead time. After publishing, open the **Monitor** tab to watch sessions, resolution and escalation outcomes, and quality trends over time, and to see where users drop off.

Try These Live

Sample queries to test your agent during the build-along.

Queue Triage

Show all High priority cases currently breaching SLA. · Which categories have the most New cases this week?

Plain-Language Drafting

Draft an acknowledgement letter for CIT-7821, housing repair request. · Rewrite this case summary in plain English for the citizen.

SLA & Channel Mix

What's the average days-to-resolve by category? · How many cases arrived via Walk-in last week?

How to Think About This Agent

This agent replaces	With
• Manual queue categorisation • Hand-written acknowledgement letters • Spreadsheet SLA tracking refreshed by hand	✓ Consistent triage decisions, audit-trailed ✓ Plain-language letters drafted in seconds ✓ SLA risk surfaced before a breach

Trusted, governed, enterprise AI.

Built once, used everywhere.



Tip for real-world use

Publish to a custom website channel; many front-line officers do not have a Teams licence. Use accessibility checks on the Word template (alt text, reading order, language tags) so generated letters meet your accessibility standard from day one.

You've built a Copilot Studio agent ✓

You now have an AI agent that can:

- Triage and categorise new cases
- Surface SLA risk before breach
- Draft plain-language letters
- Standardise citizen experience